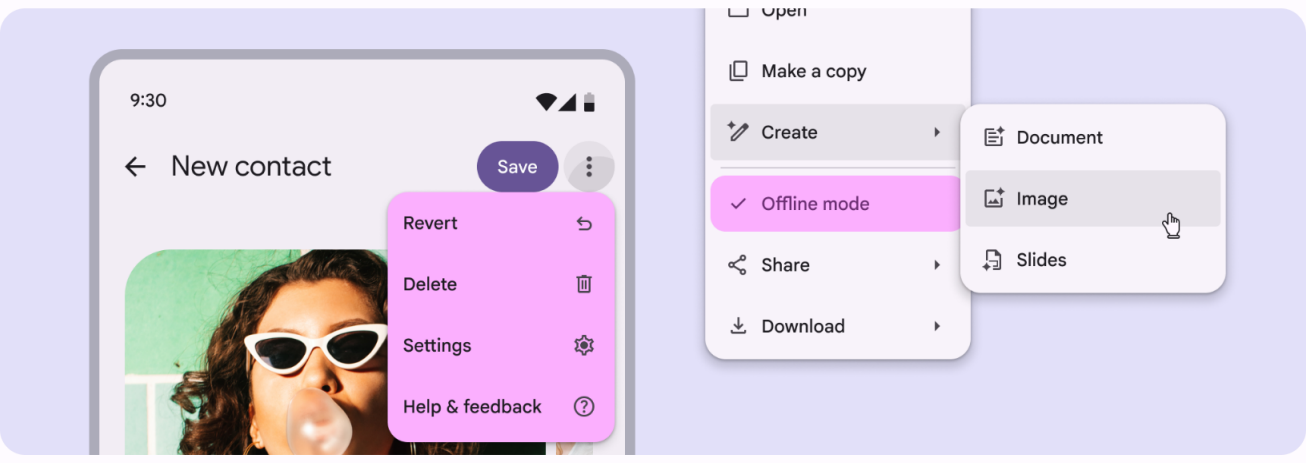
# Menus

Resources +3

- Use a **menu** to show a temporary set of actions. To show actions on screen at all times, use a **toolbar** instead
- Menus can open from many components, including icon buttons, split buttons, and text fields
- **Context menus** provide actions for a specific element, like an image or highlighted text, and usually open with a secondary click




Vertical menus can include vibrant colors, gaps, dividers, and submenus to organize a list of choices

## M3 Expressive update

**November 2025**

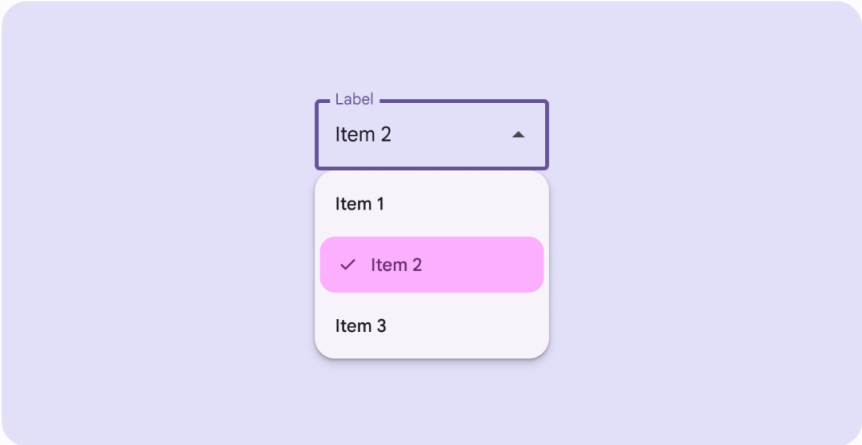
**Vertical menus** were introduced with new shapes, color styles, selection states, and refined submenu motion. Gaps can be used for a more flexible layout on Android. More on M3 Expressive

Variants:

- Added **vertical menus**, recommended for new designs
- Baseline **menu** is still available

Color styles:

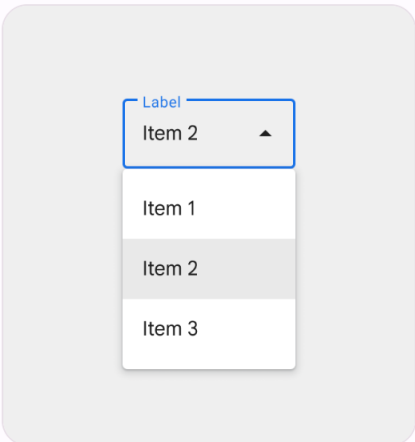
- Standard
- Vibrant




Vibrant colors help selected menu items stand out

## Differences from M2

- **Color**: New color mappings and compatibility with dynamic color
- **Variants**: Dropdown menu and exposed dropdown menu are now both referred to as menu, since they differ only in the element which opens the menu surface




M2: Former menu colors don't contrast with the background

M3: Menus feature new color mappings and dynamic color